



FILM + TV PRIVATE CREDIT INSIGHTS

"Media Finance in a Changing Economy"

2022

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The film and TV industry continues to recover from the pandemic.

At FilmHedge, we receive applications from filmmakers all over the world. In 2021, 403 films were released in the United States and Canada. In the same year, 366 productions were produced in the state of Georgia, a leading destination for film and TV production. [1]

To put our data in perspective, in 2021 FilmHedge received applications from around 100 productions, 40 of which were features with total budgets above \$1M and below \$50M, our area of focus. Films of this size are an important part of our work in independently financed production.

We didn't allocate funding to all of these productions, but our review of these deals gives us insight into the state of film finance. This data helps FilmHedge's capital partners evaluate lending decisions for film and TV producers.

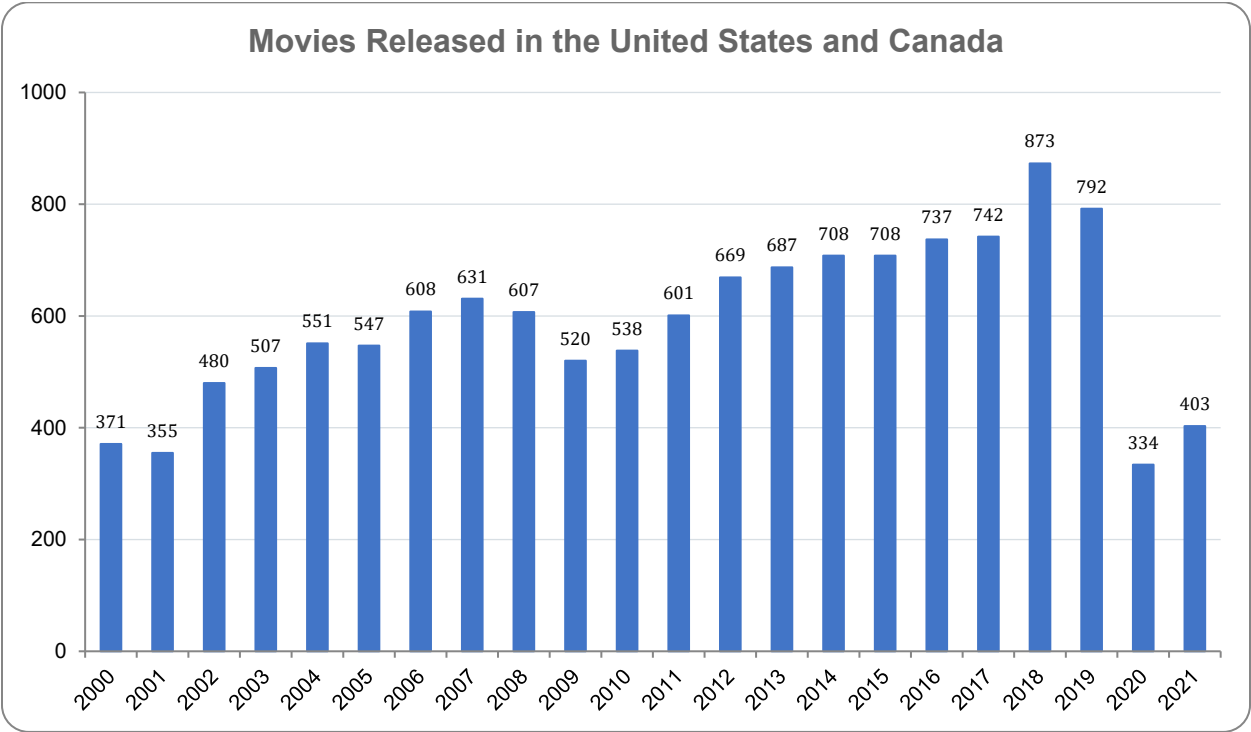
This report shares insights into how the industry is evolving from a financial data perspective. To respect the privacy of the individual filmmakers and producers, we have anonymized the names of each production analyzed.

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Putting the Data in Perspective



Source: Box Office Mojo / Statista, © Statista 2022. Values transcribed from the chart in the original report. [1]

The 40 features in FilmHedge’s 2021 focus cohort are roughly 9.93% of the 403 releases shown above. This comparison gives a sense of scale; it does not mean FilmHedge reviewed 10% of films released that year.

Projects may apply for financing long before they are released. Our applicants also come from different locations globally, while the release chart only covers the United States and Canada. When comparing our pipeline with these industry totals, we actually cover more ground.

Georgia’s mix of film and TV production differs from our feature-film focus. The figures presented here do not establish how much of Georgia’s production activity FilmHedge reviewed.

Summary

This report analyzes financial trends in private media finance and lending to film and TV producers. It considers what those trends may mean for producers, investors and lenders.

These insights explore market changes that may affect how and when film and TV producers can access capital, and what the investors and lenders who finance them can expect.

About the Data

The data in this report is not comprehensive of the film and TV industry. It is limited to publicly available data sets and a selected sample of productions submitted to FilmHedge or its affiliates.

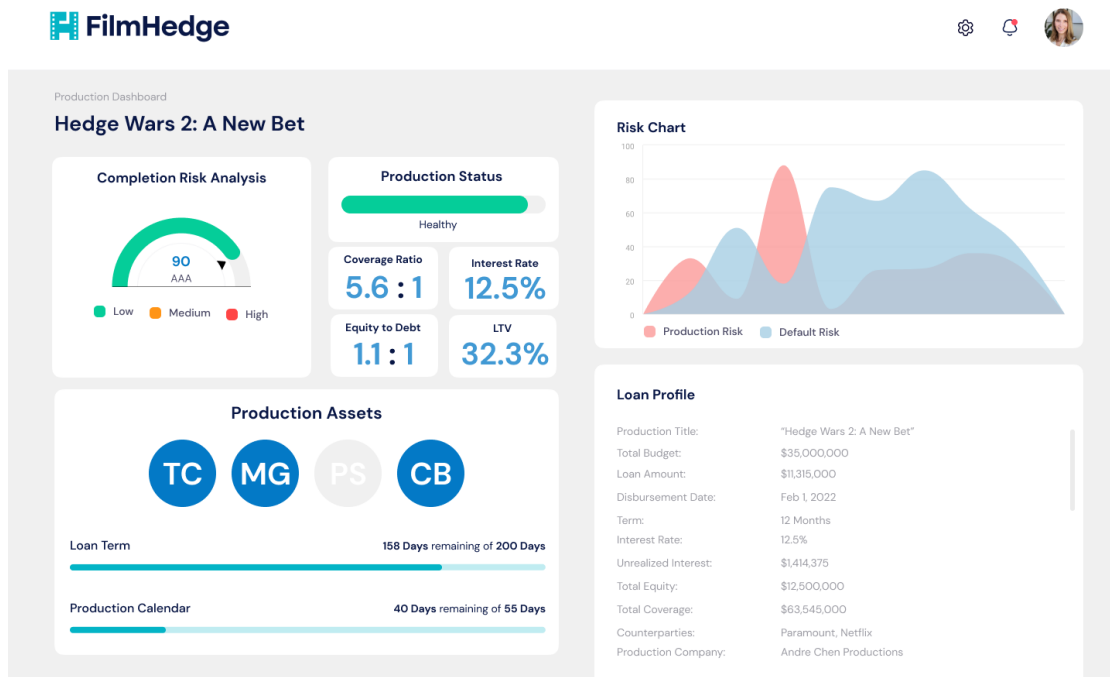
The nature of film and TV is such that projects produced in one year are often not released until the following year, or even many years later. When looking at this sample of projects financed or partially financed in 2022, some have already been released while others may not be released until 2023 or subsequent years.

FilmHedge reviews productions that are often not yet public, so much of the data in this report can't be found on public resources such as IMDb.com.

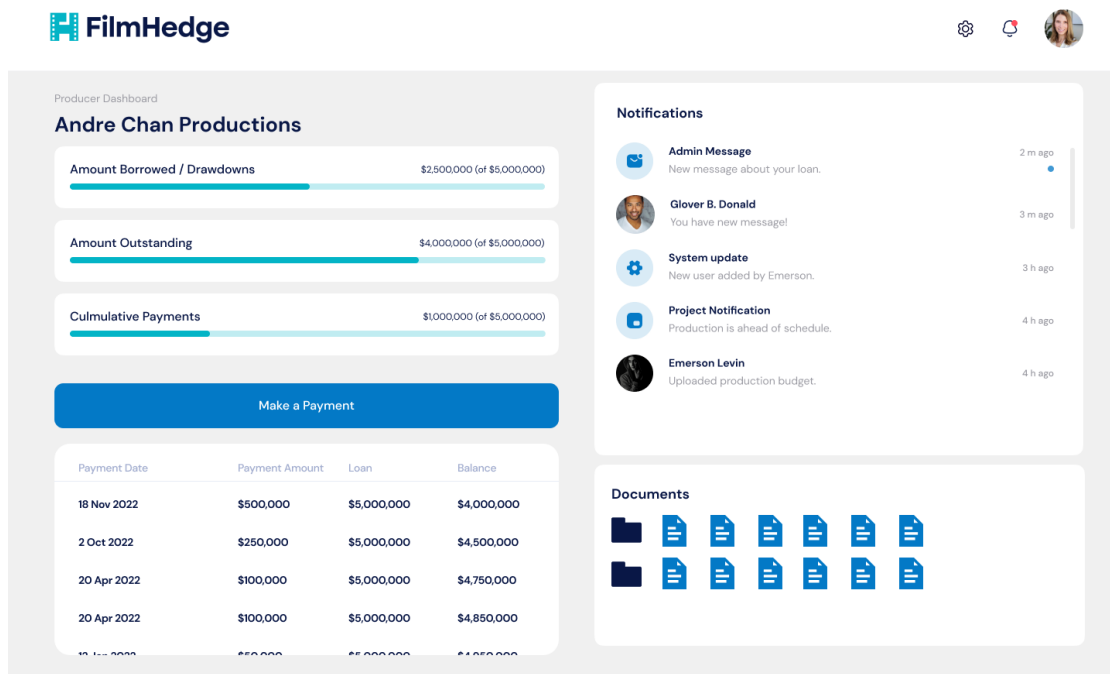
The detailed production table contains 10 transactions: nine features and one series. Other sections describe a wider application pipeline and separate lending observations. Those groups should not be treated as one uniform sample.

Edition note: This is an edited reconstruction of a report published in 2022. References to 2022, 2023, then-current products, rates and contacts retain their original period context. Calculations use only figures contained in the report. Source conflicts and missing support are identified where they affect the analysis.

The FilmHedge Platform



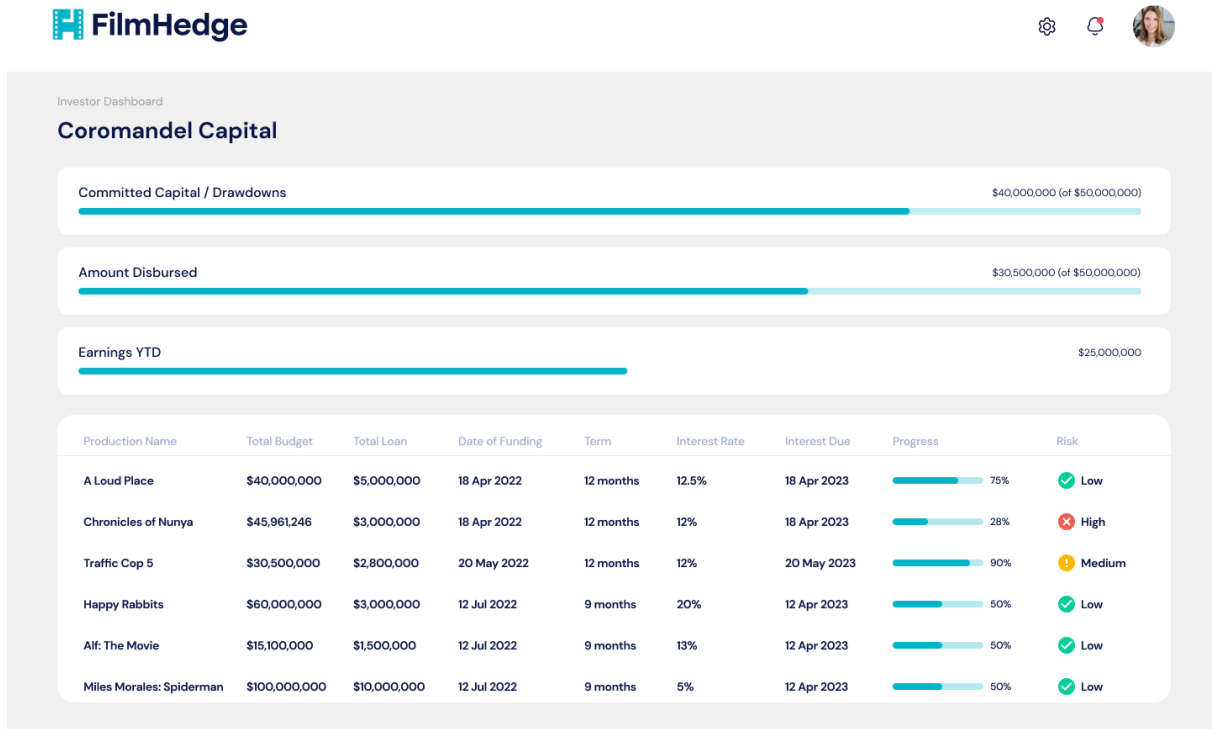
At FilmHedge, we offer a fintech platform with features for investors and lenders who want access to better data to guide their media lending.



We also offer tools for producers to apply for and receive funding.

Data from Both Sides of the Transaction

Because we work with both lenders and borrowers across the U.S. film and TV industry, and increasingly the global industry, we have access to financial data from both sides of these transactions.



The data we collect is not limited to transactions from a single financial group. In addition to our own deal flow, we track deals financed by third parties.

Media Finance Data Set

Using data collected from completed transactions tracked by FilmHedge, we compiled the following data set. These qualified productions closed with financing from the partners we work with. The table supports some of the findings in this report.

Media Finance Study: 2022 Sample Data Set [2]

Amounts in U.S. dollars. Production names are anonymized.

Production	Type	ATL	BTL	Post	TXC	Total budget
Crimson	Feature	1,116,385	5,117,210	1,316,716	-	7,780,000
Stain	Series	6,317,285	17,982,714	2,412,989	8,100,000	27,000,000
Jane	Feature	4,648,314	9,118,977	1,039,285	4,856,637	16,582,490
Slay	Feature	4,442,288	5,157,711	281,771	2,499,614	9,600,000
Dirt	Feature	2,469,729	2,688,489	182,481	935,000	5,358,219
Buddies	Feature	560,807	898,835	144,452	425,000	1,596,057
Lady	Feature	302,976	1,394,342	172,515	200,000	1,608,784
Army	Feature	15,839,142	10,519,858	1,672,728	-	28,259,000
Dog	Feature	2,649,396	2,180,106	306,547	1,468,170	5,581,050
Lib	Feature	4,512,405	6,887,908	1,820,000	4,458,975	14,863,250

ATL = above-the-line costs; BTL = below-the-line costs; Post = post-production; TXC = tax credits. Tax credits are a financing source and are not added to production costs.

Data note: The amounts are retained from the original detailed table. ATL, BTL and Post do not consistently reconcile to total budget. They exceed the stated budget for "Slay," "Buddies" and "Lady"; the report does not explain whether costs overlap or figures are incorrect. See the cost analysis for the differences.

The original ATL/BTL comparison table gives "Buddies" BTL as \$1,035,250 rather than \$898,835. This reconstruction uses \$898,835 from the detailed table consistently; the conflict remains unresolved.

I. The Outlook For Producers



FILM/TV PRODUCTION ANALYSIS

In this section, we share our research and observations for film and TV producers. Our pipeline shows growing interest in mid-range productions, while the transaction data offers a closer look at how those productions budget and finance their work.

Mid-Range Boom

Movies made for under \$50M continue to attract attention. *EVERYTHING EVERYWHERE ALL AT ONCE* had a reported budget of \$25M and went on to earn over \$100M worldwide. [3]



Filmmakers are showing what they can achieve with mid-range budgets. At our company, we've seen an uptick in applicants in this range: from 40 in 2021, about 0.8 per week, to 260 in 2022, about 5 per week. That is a 550% increase in applicant count.

These counts include productions still in development, at the screenplay-only stage. "Qualified" applicants are producers submitting films or series where pre-production has begun, principal photography has started, or more than 50% of the budget has been committed.

Film and TV Deals Reviewed for Study

Applicants in focus cohort	2021	2022
Overall applicants	40	260
Qualified applicants	8	52
Qualified share	20%	20%

The 40 applicants shown for 2021 are the focus cohort discussed in the introduction, within approximately 100 total submissions. The report does not supply a comparable all-submission total for 2022.

Productions: ATL vs. BTL Costs

Qualified applicants accounted for 20% of the focus cohort in both years. Our production analysis focuses on qualified deal flow; the displayed sample is further limited to productions that secured distribution, giving them a more definite release schedule.

Observations

For producers working in the \$1M to \$30M range, the transactions in this report offer useful examples of private financing. The sample does not establish that this budget range has more financing options than productions above or below it.

Production Costs and Reconciliation (U.S. dollars)

Production	ATL	BTL	Total budget	Residual*
Crimson	1,116,385	5,117,210	7,780,000	229,689
Stain	6,317,285	17,982,714	27,000,000	287,012
Jane	4,648,314	9,118,977	16,582,490	1,775,914
Slay	4,442,288	5,157,711	9,600,000	-281,770
Dirt	2,469,729	2,688,489	5,358,219	17,520
Buddies	560,807	898,835	1,596,057	-8,037
Lady	302,976	1,394,342	1,608,784	-261,049
Army	15,839,142	10,519,858	28,259,000	227,272
Dog	2,649,396	2,180,106	5,581,050	445,001
Lib	4,512,405	6,887,908	14,863,250	1,642,937

* Residual = total budget minus ATL, BTL and Post, using the detailed data table. It is an unexplained difference, not an identified contingency or legal-cost allowance. Negative amounts mean the listed costs exceed the stated budget.

"Buddies" uses the detailed table's BTL of \$898,835. If the alternative \$1,035,250 is used, its residual is -\$144,452 rather than -\$8,037.

Reading the Cost Mix

In film production, the people responsible for creative work, including screen talent, are considered “above the line.” The crew and day-to-day production work are considered “below the line.”

Is there noticeable cost-cutting on one side of the camera or the other? The data here is a snapshot, so it cannot show how either category changed over time.

Across the 10 productions, the simple average of each production’s cost share is 34.6% for ATL, 55.7% for BTL and 8.2% for Post. Using aggregate dollars instead gives 36.3%, 52.4% and 7.9%, respectively. These figures use the detailed table and remain subject to its reconciliation issues.

Observations

Below-the-line spending exceeds above-the-line spending on average in this sample. That is a useful reference point when building a budget, but it does not establish a lender’s preferred allocation or show that expensive talent is irrelevant to financing.

The legal, financial and cost structure of a film needs to make sense as a whole. Use these figures as a discussion point with lenders, alongside the production’s own creative and financial requirements.

Contingency Budgets

Our reported observation was that contingency budgets remained flat after increasing in 2020 and 2021, potentially reflecting costs related to COVID-19. The year-by-year contingency figures are not included in the report.

The reported average contingency for productions in the \$10M to \$15M range was \$700K. Against those budget endpoints, \$700K represents approximately 4.7% to 7.0%.

Contingency Budgets: Observations

One interpretation is that, even as COVID-19 conditions changed in 2022, producers remained reluctant to remove related protections for cast and crew. The contingency figures alone do not establish that explanation.

Producers can use the reported \$700K figure as a reference point for comparable budgets, while allowing for the specific risks and requirements of their own productions.

Debt Financing on the Rise

Producers can use debt instruments to finance production. Media-specific “paper,” such as tax incentives that can be brokered to buyers, can help support access to debt.

Our study reported that more than 55% of production budgets, on average, were financed with some type of debt, and that this share was driven mainly by films with budgets over \$10M. The report does not include the debt amounts by production, so these observations cannot be independently recalculated from the displayed data.

Observations

Smaller-budget films may pursue a different balance of equity and debt than mid-range productions. Larger budgets require larger commitments, which can make lenders an important part of the financing plan.

The reported observations suggest a role for debt across the mid-range, but this sample does not establish that films under \$10M find equity easier to raise, or that more expensive films are inherently more attractive to lenders.

SPOTLIGHT ON GEORGIA

As a leading destination for film and TV production, Georgia offers a useful view of a major production market. Its experience should not be treated as a proxy for the whole country. [4]



In this section, we share our research and observations for Georgia-based productions.

Georgia Rises as a Production Destination

In only a decade, Georgia has emerged as a major destination for film and TV producers. The state's robust tax incentives, cost of living, internationally accessible airport and other factors have helped build momentum in Atlanta. The figures through FY2022 show a strong recovery in production activity.

Georgia's Production Incentives



Georgia's Entertainment Industry Investment Act was passed in 2005. Initially, it provided a 10% tax incentive for production companies spending money in the state. Three years later, that tax credit was increased to 20%, with an additional 10% offered to productions including a "Made in Georgia" logo in their end credits.

The incentive has helped support a production boom in Georgia over the years, bringing notable productions such as THE WALKING DEAD, STRANGER THINGS and OZARK, which completed filming its final season in the state last year.

Historical policy description and production examples retained from the original 2022 report.

Georgia-Lensed Production Data (2018-2022)

Fiscal year	Productions	Direct spend	Estimated impact*
FY2018	455	\$2,700,000,000	\$7,344,000,000
FY2019	399	\$2,900,000,000	\$7,888,000,000
FY2020	234	\$2,200,000,000	\$5,984,000,000
FY2021	366	\$4,000,000,000	\$10,880,000,000
FY2022	412	\$4,400,000,000	\$11,968,000,000

Production counts in Georgia rebounded significantly in FY2022, up 12.6% from FY2021 and 3.3% from FY2019. Direct spending increased 10.0% from FY2021, from \$4.0B to \$4.4B.

Georgia Film Recovers from COVID-19

The COVID-19 pandemic disrupted production around the world in 2020. In Georgia, production counts fell 41.35% from FY2019 to FY2020. The annual figures do not show how activity was distributed across quarters.

FY2021 brought an improvement of 56.41% over FY2020, although production counts remained 8.3% below FY2019 levels.

FY2022's numbers suggest a return to pre-pandemic activity as measured against FY2019. Production counts were still 9.5% below FY2018, so the recovery depends on the baseline. The data ends in FY2022 and does not establish whether growth accelerated heading into 2023.

* Estimated impact = direct spend × 2.72. The report derives 2.72 as the simple average of 1.87, attributed to GSU economist Bruce Seaman, and 3.57, attributed to the Georgia Department of Economic Development. All five displayed impact amounts recalculate correctly. This is an illustrative estimate based on the chosen multiplier, not a separately measured outcome. [5]

II. THE OUTLOOK FOR INVESTORS AND LENDERS



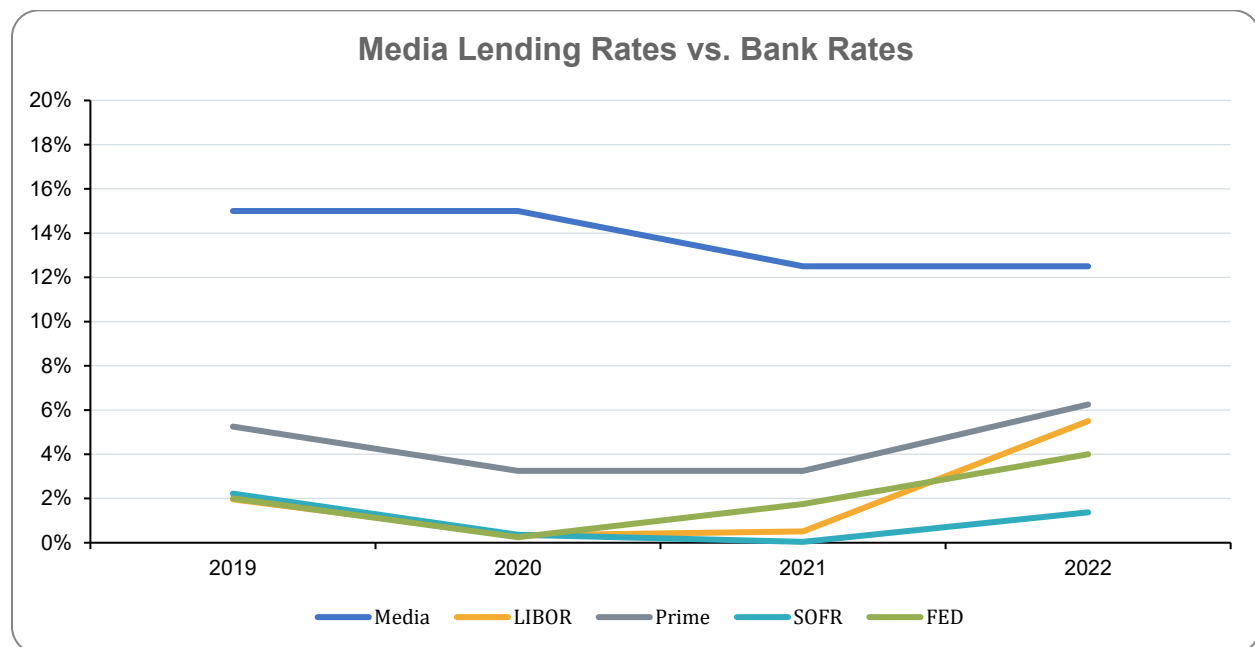
Lender/Investor Analysis

In this section, we share our research and observations for film and TV lenders and investors.

The rates charged to film and TV borrowers can differ from mortgage or small-business lending rates. Media lending has its own mix of risk factors, security types and credit protections.

Film and TV borrowers have traditionally paid a premium for capital. The figures that follow compare the report's media lending observations with selected bank benchmarks.

Media Lending Rates vs. Bank Rates



Rate	2019	2020	2021	2022
Media	15.00%	15.00%	12.50%	12.50%
LIBOR	1.96%	0.33%	0.51%	5.50%
Prime	5.25%	3.25%	3.25%	6.25%
SOFR	2.22%	0.36%	0.04%	1.37%
FED	2.00%	0.25%	1.75%	4.00%

The reported media rate fell from 15.0% in 2020 to 12.5% in 2021 and remained at 12.5% in 2022. Each displayed bank benchmark rose between 2021 and 2022. In that interval, the reported media rate did not move in the same direction as those benchmarks.

Comparability note: Benchmark figures are reproduced from the original report. Exact observation dates, tenors and averaging conventions are not consistently specified. The table cannot support a precise pricing spread, a statistical correlation conclusion or a forecast of borrower loan rates.

What Rising Bank Rates May Mean

Rising bank rates may make private lending more attractive to some producers if the total cost and transaction terms are competitive. Speed, certainty of execution and the structure of a production can also matter.

Why might producers consider a private lender? A lender that can move quickly may offer an advantage on a time-sensitive production. The figures here do not compare closing times, fees or actual bank offers to the same borrowers.

One possible explanation for lower reported media rates is increased competition for deals. That remains an interpretation: the report does not isolate competition from changes in borrower quality, loan structure or the mix of transactions.

Observations

As media lending becomes more common, lenders may face pressure to compete on price and terms. For now, the reported media rate was unchanged between 2021 and 2022, even as the displayed bank benchmarks rose. That does not mean media lending is immune to changes in financing costs.

Bank Rate Definitions and Sources

LIBOR - London Interbank Offered Rate, a benchmark associated with unsecured interbank borrowing. The original report describes a “12-month trailing average” measured at December year-end, but does not identify a currency, tenor or a reproducible observation method.

FED - The federal funds rate, associated with overnight lending between banks. The original table does not specify which rate measure or observation date it uses.

Prime - A reference rate banks use in pricing loans to their most creditworthy customers.

SOFR - The Secured Overnight Financing Rate, a broad measure of the cost of borrowing cash overnight collateralized by U.S. Treasury securities.

The original data-source links are retained in the references. Benchmark values have not been refreshed or externally validated for this reconstruction.

Film/TV Private Lending

Alongside the rise in mid-range applicants in our pipeline, the number of financiers serving these productions appears to be growing. The report identifies the following banks and other financial groups:

- City National Bank, also known as “The Bank of Hollywood”
- JPMorgan Media Finance
- Bank of America
- Comerica
- National Bank
- Redbird Capital
- Shamrock Capital
- Arena Capital
- Baypoint Capital
- Media Finance Capital
- Three Point Capital
- BondIt Media
- Other emerging groups

Financial groups like these participate in film and TV financing through different combinations of debt and equity. Some serve productions that fall outside the size, track-record or underwriting requirements of other lenders.

Observations

Producers have a range of financing groups to consider. This list illustrates that range; without comparable counts over time, it does not establish how quickly the lender market is growing.

Media Lending Rates Decline

The average media lending rate reported here fell from 15% in 2019 and 2020 to 12.5% in 2021 and 2022. That is a decline of 2.5 percentage points, or 16.7% relative to the earlier rate. It did not decline further between 2021 and 2022.

Media Finance Interest Rates [6]

Report category	2019	2020	2021	2022
Average	15%	15%	12.5%	12.5%
Media Prime	7.5%	7.5%	5%	5%
Media Standard	22.5%	22.5%	20%	20%
Media High	30%	30%	27.5%	27.5%

In 2022, Media Prime and Media Standard were 7.5 percentage points below and above the reported average, respectively. Media High was 15 percentage points above it. The full displayed range was 5% to 27.5%, a span of 22.5 percentage points.

These are the report's category labels. The source does not provide category criteria, transaction counts, weights or rate-calculation conventions. "Average" cannot be independently reconstructed from the three named categories.

Why Might Media Rates Fall as Bank Rates Rise?

Our interpretation is that competition for qualified productions may have put pressure on media lending rates. Private lenders can also compete on flexibility and execution. The data does not show that competition alone caused the decline.

Observations

As of Q4 2022, some media lenders may have faced a rising cost of capital while competing for production opportunities. That could affect the rates and terms available to producers. The reported figures suggest lower average media pricing than in 2019 and 2020; they do not guarantee cheaper capital or more available funding for every borrower.

Lender Earnings from TV/Film Transactions

In our analysis of closed private transactions financed by FilmHedge, our partners or unrelated parties, we observed the following reported returns:

Reported Transaction Returns and Terms

Transaction-size label*	Avg. net ROI	Avg. term	Simple annualized equivalent**
>\$1M	10.00%	11 months	10.91%
\$1M-\$10M	11.50%	11 months	12.55%
\$10M+	12.34%	10 months	14.81%
Simple mean of groups	11.28%	10.67 months	12.75%

* Size labels are reproduced as printed. ">\$1M" overlaps the other groups, and the \$10M boundary also overlaps. The intended group definitions cannot be resolved from the report. ** Simple annualized equivalent = reported ROI × 12 ÷ reported term in months. This scales each group's return to 12 months without compounding. It is illustrative, not a realized annual portfolio return or a forecast. *** The last row weights each of the three groups equally. The source's 11.28% "blended" ROI equals this simple mean, but transaction weights are not supplied.

The reported returns exclude equity, mezzanine and backend earnings. They are described as net earned interest above original principal; the report does not specify which expenses, funding costs or credit losses are included in "net."

Observations

The reported group averages range from 10.00% to 12.34% over 10 to 11 months. The \$10M+ group shows the highest average percentage return and the shortest average term in this table.

Comparing TV/Film and Real Estate Returns

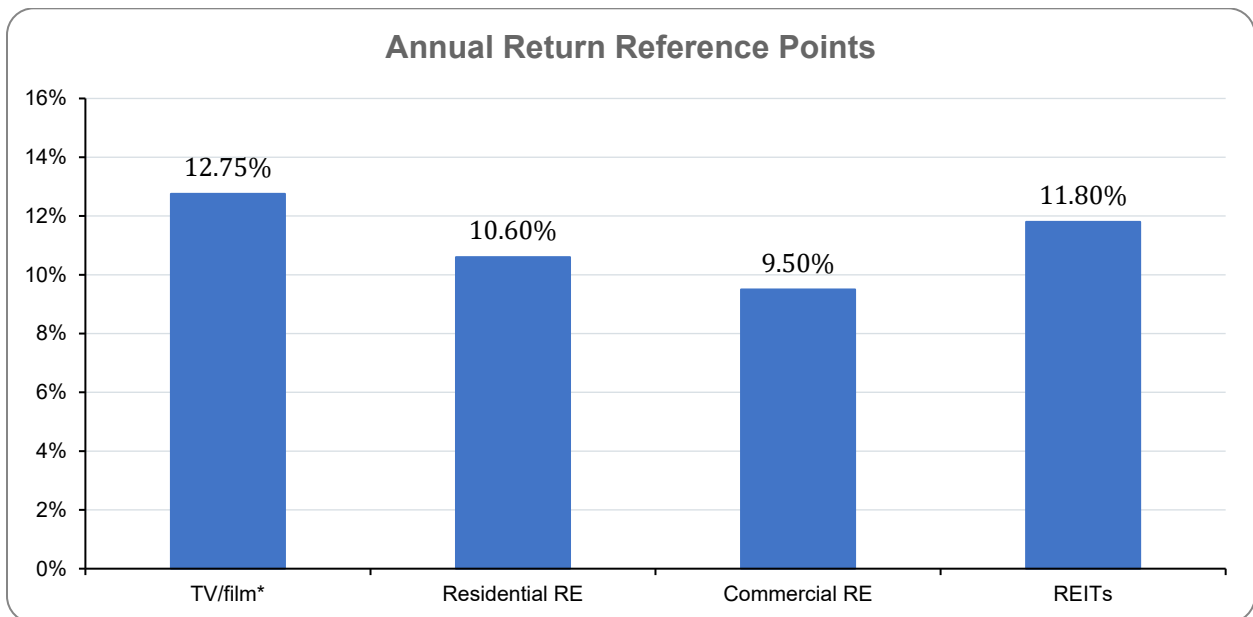


U.S. real estate returns of 10.6% for residential real estate, 9.5% for commercial real estate and 11.8% for REITs. Those figures are retained here as historical reference points. The source links do not specify a common measurement period or net-return methodology in the report itself. ^[7, 8]

Return Figures and Their Measurement Basis

Category	Return	Period / basis
TV/film lending groups	11.28%	Simple mean of reported returns over 10-11 months
TV/film, annualized illustration	12.75%	Simple mean of group annualized equivalents
Residential real estate	10.60%	Annual figure cited in original report
Commercial real estate	9.50%	Annual figure cited in original report
REITs	11.80%	Annual figure cited in original report

What the Return Comparison Can Tell Us



* TV/film is an illustrative simple annualized equivalent (12.75%), equally weighting three reported group averages. Real estate figures are annual statistics cited by the original report. Periods, costs, risks and methodologies are not matched.

The reported figures put film and TV lending in a range that may interest investors exploring income opportunities.

Observations

Investors looking beyond their current industry exposure may find film and TV lending worth exploring. Assess the production, repayment sources and loan terms on their own merits; the averages here are a starting point for that discussion, not a promise of returns.

CONCLUSIONS

Film and TV finance remains a specialized area of lending, and one that more financiers are exploring. It can offer investors exposure to a different industry, although this report does not measure the resulting portfolio-diversification benefit.

For producers, our growing application pipeline shows interest in financing mid-range productions. The completed-transaction sample offers useful budget reference points, while also showing why careful review of the underlying figures matters.

For lenders, the reported transaction returns warrant a closer look. The figures should be evaluated alongside the repayment structure, transaction costs and risks of each opportunity.

2023 is a good time to explore how investing in this space could expand your investment portfolio.

Contact

If you'd like to learn more about opportunities in the space, contact our team at FilmHedge.

Lenders and investors interested in learning more about opportunities can contact:

lender@filmhedge.com

TV and film producers can email:

producer@filmhedge.com

If you have a question about the data in this report or want to consult our data team, contact:

data@filmhedge.com

References Retained from the Original Report

These references reproduce the source trail in the 2022 report.

1. [Statista: Number of movies released in the United States and Canada](#)
2. Production data set: FilmHedge and affiliates
3. [The Numbers: Everything Everywhere All at Once \(2022\)](#)
4. [Film industry in Georgia \(U.S. state\)](#)
5. Economic-impact method: 2.72 multiplier, derived in the original report from 1.87 and 3.57.
6. Media rate analysis: deals from various media lending groups, 2019-2022.
7. [S&P Dow Jones Indices: S&P 500 overview \(original citation\)](#)
8. [Bankrate: ROI on Real Estate](#)

Bank Rate Data Sources

[Global Rates: LIBOR](#)

[Wall Street Journal prime rate history](#)

[Global Rates: SOFR](#)

[Global Rates: U.S. Federal Reserve interest rate](#)

Additional Citations

[Fox28: Film and TV Production Post Record Numbers for Georgia in FY2019](#)

[AtlantaFi: Georgia #1 in Film Production in 2020](#)

[Georgia Made Film & TV Productions Generate \\$4.4B for State](#)

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